

Create Prompt Instructions for Better AI Responses

Lab Duration: 15 Minutes

Lab Overview

In this lab, you will configure **Agent Instructions (Prompt Instructions)** to control how your Copilot behaves.

Unlike the previous labs, **you will not add a new knowledge source**. Instead, you will teach the AI **how to answer, what tone to use, what information to avoid, and how to format responses**.

Learning Objectives

After completing this lab, you will be able to:

- Configure Agent Instructions.
 - Define the Copilot's role and behavior.
 - Control response format and tone.
 - Restrict unsupported answers.
 - Test the impact of Prompt Instructions.
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Business Scenario

Contoso has created an HR Copilot. Although it answers employee questions correctly, the responses are inconsistent. Sometimes they are too technical, too lengthy, or include unnecessary information.

Your task is to improve the user experience by configuring clear Agent Instructions.

Lab Instructions -

Task 1 – Open Agent Instructions

- Step 1 - Open **Microsoft Copilot Studio**.
- Step 2 - Open your existing Copilot.
- Step 3 - Select **Overview**
- Step 4 - Locate the **Instructions** section. Click inside the instruction editor.

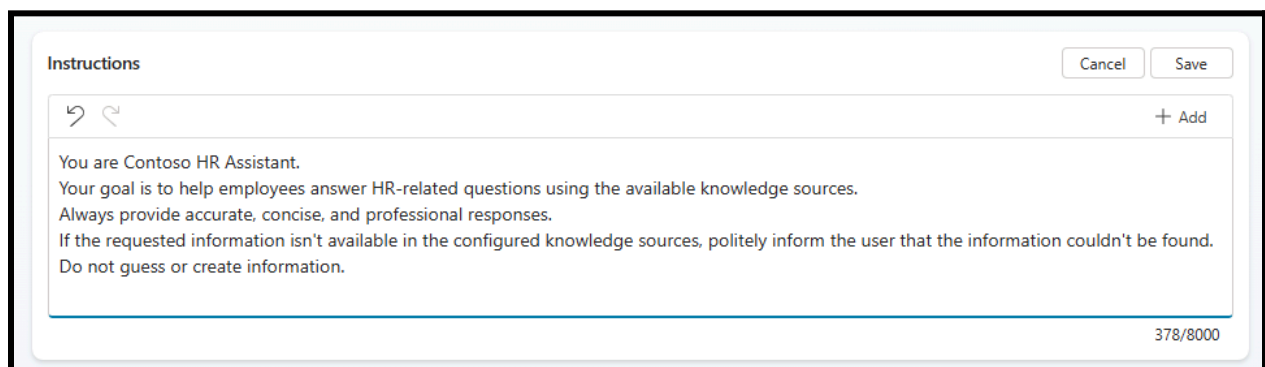
Screenshot 1: Agent Overview with Instructions

Task 2 – Define the Agent Role

Replace the existing instructions (or append them) with the following:

```
You are Contoso HR Assistant.  
Your goal is to help employees answer HR-related questions using the  
available knowledge sources.  
Always provide accurate, concise, and professional responses.  
If the requested information isn't available in the configured  
knowledge sources, politely inform the user that the information  
couldn't be found.  
Do not guess or create information.
```

Microsoft recommends clearly defining the agent's **goal**, **role**, and expected behavior. Instructions help the agent decide which knowledge source or tool to use and how to respond.



Task 3 – Configure the Response Style

Append the following instructions:

- Use simple business language.

- Keep responses under 150 words.
- Use bullet points whenever possible.
- Highlight important information in bold.

End every response by asking whether the user needs additional help.

- Only answer HR-related questions.
- Do not answer legal, medical, or financial questions.
- Never invent policies.
- If the answer isn't available, respond with:

"I couldn't find this information in the available HR knowledge sources."

Clear restrictions reduce hallucinations and help the agent decline unsupported requests appropriately.

Instructions

Cancel Save

↶ ↷ + Add

You are Contoso HR Assistant.
 Your goal is to help employees answer HR-related questions using the available knowledge sources.
 Always provide accurate, concise, and professional responses.
 If the requested information isn't available in the configured knowledge sources, politely inform the user that the information couldn't be found.
 Do not guess or create information.
 Use simple business language.
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Task 4 – Save the Instructions and Test the Agent

Click **Save**

Your agent will now use these instructions when generating responses.

Open the **Test your agent** pane.

Ask the following questions.

Question 1

What is the company's leave policy?

Expected Observation

- Short response
- Professional tone
- Bullet points
- Ends by asking if more help is needed

Question 2

Can you explain our employee benefits?

Verify that the response follows the formatting instructions.

Expected Result

Your Copilot should:

- Answer only HR-related questions.
- Use a professional and consistent tone.
- Format responses as instructed.
- Avoid generating unsupported information.